

Geography

U.S.





About the Course

Join the Page family as they travel from California to Washington, D.C. While this story is set in the U.S.A., the point of the book is really to explore basic geography concepts such as landforms, water bodies, maps, and regions, so it is suitable for students from any nation. Students use the globe, atlases, and models. Students also make models and draw maps of places important to them, such as their neighborhood.



Placement & Combining Tips

This course progresses chronologically over two years. Students who did not take Geography Foundations may wish to incorporate those lessons into the afternoons. This course is intended to follow Grade 2; however, the levels may be reversed in order to combine students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3	Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) 2 times/week 20 min	50 Adventures in the 50 States Cross Country: Geography for Children Grandma Gatewood Hikes the Appalachian Trail United States Atlas 7th Ed. Student World Atlas 6th Ed.

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)				
Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)		Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

☐ Print the maps needed for some of the future lessons. You will find the map links in the prep section of each lesson.

☐ Print the 5th edition map PDF linked below in the Quick Links section for lessons that use economic symbols. (not in the 6th edition of the U.S. atlas)

☐ Check the Appendix for tips on creating geography models and relief maps.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)



50 Adventures in the 50 States



Cross Country: Geography for Children



Grandma Gatewood Hikes the Appalachian Trail



United States Atlas 7th Ed.



Student World Atlas 6th Ed.



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)



Globe



Household Items - Geography: Grade 3



Quick Links

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

∞ [Appendix: Geography Models](#)

∞ [5th Edition U.S. Map PDF](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 16: Geography\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

How To Teach

	Overview The steps below are generally true for most geography lessons. Sometimes several lessons might build together or focus on a particular area (like Map Work).
	Introduce Through questions, observations, an activity, or recalling the last lesson, introduce the topic for the day.
	Map Questions Answer questions on the map or on making your own maps.
	Read Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently.
	Narrate Have students retell the passage either orally or in writing. They may want to use maps or pictures to tell back.
	Map Work The lesson may contain more map work as students make their own maps or add to ongoing maps.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

What do you remember from last year's readings? (You can read the titles of sections or show a few illustrations from last year's readings to help.)

Let's look at the map in the front of the Cross-Country book. What do you notice? Do you see the red line? Remember that this book is about a family that travels along that line (route) across the United States.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Locate Los Angeles. Put your finger on it, and then trace with your finger the red line across the United States to Washington, D.C.
2. Locate Denver, Colorado. Our journey will start just east of Denver, but let's find out a little bit about the area before we read.

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The West: The Region" and "The West: Physical Map" p.126-127, 128

1. First, locate Colorado on the Physical Map, and then find the outline of Colorado on the Region map.
2. What do you notice about the terrain in the middle of Colorado? (Hopefully, you notice that the mountains end suddenly. You could start on the west coast and run your finger eastward to mid-Colorado, asking what changes there.)
3. On the Physical Map, try to find a label for the region in eastern Colorado that extends from Montana to Texas. (Great Plains)

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Climate" p.10-11

1. Locate Colorado.
2. Using the map legend, what can you tell about the climate in Colorado?
3. How does it change from the western side to the eastern side of the state? (Cooler and wetter toward the west. The eastern part is more dry.)

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

The Great Plains

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

PREP: Print Map: "My U.S. Map" (blank U.S. map) or use the one you made last year.

Map Link: blank U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Have you ever read Little House on the Prairie? What do you think the prairie looks like? (If needed, have students study the picture on p.61 of Cross-Country and discuss what they see.)

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8-9

1. Locate Colorado.
2. Look at the map legend to identify the vegetation in eastern Colorado.
3. What do you think grassland will look like?
4. Locate your home state and your general location. (You may look at p.14-15 if needed to help find your state.)
5. How does the vegetation of your home compare with that of eastern Colorado?

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Look for the vegetation found during Map Questions from today's lesson.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.62-63 "Mother and Father" - "made the cattle fat."

→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Add the Blank US Map to your geography journal if not in there from last year.
2. Add the title "My US Map" (making sure the title does not cover any states).
3. Label Colorado if not already labeled from last year.
4. Draw a cow in the eastern half of the state.

WEEK 2 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

The Great Plains (cont.)

□ Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

We read yesterday that the Pages drove on straight roads. Why do you think the roads were straight? (flat land) Do you remember what the roads were like in the mountains? ("winding" and "ran up and down" on p.42 of Cross-Country)

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8-9

1. Locate the Great Plains.
2. Through which states does it run? (Montana, North Dakota, South Dakota, Wyoming, Nebraska, Colorado, Kansas, Oklahoma, Texas, and New Mexico)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.64 "In a little town" - "very much alike."

→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Similar to the Rocky Mountains label from last year, label the Great Plains so that the label slants across the map to mimic the plains stretching across multiple states. Be careful not to cover up Kansas, since that is the next stop for the Pages.

WEEK 2 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Reading Maps

□ Materials: Student World Atlas, Cross-Country

→ NOTE

The information in this lesson is a refresher from last year.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: Student World Atlas "United States: Political" p.65
Based on the global grid, which direction is north on this map?

□ Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. What is to the west of Los Angeles? (Pacific Ocean)
2. Which ocean is near Washington, D.C.? (Atlantic Ocean)
3. Is the Atlantic Ocean to the east or west of Washington, D.C.? (east)
4. If we travel from Los Angeles to Washington, D.C., which direction would you travel? (east)
5. Where do you live? Which direction would you travel to get to Los Angeles? To get to Washington, D.C.? To get to Denver, Colorado?

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

6. Come up with your own questions to give more practice on directions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Student World Atlas p.8
Direction and Scale

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

Grids and Maps

Materials: local map, Student World Atlas

PREP: Today you will need a map of your local area (or a state map, if the city cannot be found). If no options exist, print a map from a web mapping service (like Google Maps or OpenStreetMap) and draw your own grid.

→ INTRO

Do you remember that globes and maps also have a grid?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Student World Atlas p.8
“Reading Maps” and all captions—Latitude, Longitude, and Global Grid

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Your local map

1. Spend some time calling out grid cells; for example, “Locate G4.”
2. When this is mastered, move on to specific places with the following types of questions.
3. What grid cell is your home in?
4. Where is your church, grocery store, bank, park, etc.? What grid cell is that in?

→ NOTE

Save your map for later lessons.

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Wheat Country

Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Link: Topography of the U.S.

1. Familiarize yourself with the color ramp in the lower right corner.
2. Locate Colorado and Kansas.
3. What do you notice about elevation as you travel east across Colorado and Kansas? (elevation decreases)
4. What do you think Kansas will look like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.65-66 “Flat land” - “what threshing means.”

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Kansas.

WEEK 4 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

Kansas

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

Have you ever held raw wheat in your hands?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “Kansas” p.94-95 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Find the wheat symbol in the map key. See how many wheat symbols you can find in Kansas.
2. Are the wheat symbols mainly found in certain areas of the state? (No, they are found throughout.)
3. What does this tell you about Kansas? (Wheat grows really well there.)

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Political United States: Political Map” p.14-15

1. How would you describe the shape of the Kansas state borders? (straight)
2. How would you describe the state borders for the previous two states, Colorado and Utah? (straight as well)
3. What do you notice about the southern border of these three (3) states? (It's the same line.)
4. The southern border follows the 37° N latitude line. Why do you think the southern borders of Kansas, Colorado, and Utah follow the same line of latitude? (Simple answers could include that the states were broken out of the same territory, that a single easy-to-find line made it easy to chop up large territories, that the line was used as a compromise between neighboring territories, or that the line already served as the extent for something to the south. All of these assumptions would be correct.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.67 “Father got out” - “said Father.”

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Wheat Threshing and Winnowing by Hand

WEEK 4 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Dust Storm

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ INTRO

What kind of storms have you seen? (Answers will vary: rain, hail, lightning, snow, etc.) Is there a difference between good storms and bad storms? (Students might find snow fun, for example, but too much can present a problem.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-70 “If the Pages” - “shake the car.”

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Add a symbol for wheat somewhere in (or near) Kansas.

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Kansas spread on p.36-37 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to see a tallgrass prairie.

Also, take a look at the illustration showing how deep natural prairie grasses grow in Kansas.

∞ Image Link: Root Systems of Prairie Grass

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Dust Storm (cont.)

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Physical United States: Natural Hazards” p.12-13

∞ Map Link: Annual Rainfall Map

1. What do you see in Kansas? (tornadoes and droughts, average annual rainfall around the median for the U.S.)
2. Do you think this area tends to be dry? Windy? Stormy?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.70-71 “Then there was a new sound” - “shaking his head.”

→ VIEW

Picture of a Dust Storm in Kansas in 2004.

∞ Image Link: Dust Storm

WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Contour Map

Materials: Clay or homemade dough (See Geography Models in the Appendix for link to make dough and recommendation for clay), dental floss

PREP: Read about how to Create a Contour Map on Education.com.

Prepare to narrate during Model section.

∞ Link: Create a Contour Map

→ INTRO

We are going to do a lesson in topography today. What do you already know (if anything) about topography?

→ MODEL

1. Read the description of contour maps and narrate what else you have learned while referring to the two images of Half Dome from the website.
2. How would you make a map of a mountain? Could you show how steep it is in different places?
3. Using dough or clay, make your own mountain, being sure to make it with variable heights (peaks).

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: your contour map

Looking at your contour map, answer the following questions.

1. What did you notice?
2. What is the steepest area?
3. How close are the lines in that area?
4. Was there a certain area of the model that was difficult to work with?
5. If so, what made that area difficult?

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Pay attention to topography on your walk, noticing elevation changes.

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

Contour Map with Color

Materials: Clay or homemade dough (See Geography Models in the Appendix for link to make dough and recommendation for clay), paint, paintbrush, dental floss, ruler

→ INTRO

We are going to do another lesson in topography today. This time, we will

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

add color.

→ MODEL

1. Refer, if necessary, to the Create a Contour Map link.
∞ Link: Create a Contour Map
2. Make a new mountain with multiple peaks.
3. Use the same technique to separate the heights.
4. Once your levels are separated, use paint or food coloring to color each layer a different color. Make a key showing which heights are which colors.
5. Replace the levels, and you can see which colors represent the highest and lowest points (elevations) of your mountain and valley model.
6. Now you have created an elevation map, not just a topographic map.

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the linked Elevation Map of the United States.

∞ Map Link: Elevation Map

1. What colors did they use for the lowest and highest elevations?
2. Your model had heights divided every inch. How does that compare with this map?

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 12

Model of Colorado and Kansas

📄 Materials: Materials for Model and Geography Models
Resource found in the Appendix

→ INTRO

Today, we will make a model of Colorado and Kansas, using elevation maps as a guide. We have a different elevation map to look at today.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

- ∞ Map Link: Topography of the U.S.
1. Zoom in to see Colorado and Kansas close up.
 2. What differences do you notice between the two states?
 3. Where are the mountains located? (Colorado, mostly in the middle of the state)
 4. Using the color ramp (key), what is the difference in height of eastern Kansas compared with western Colorado? (Depending on where you look, over 13,000 or 14,000 feet!)
 5. Where are the highest points? The lowest points? (The highest points are in the middle of Colorado, and the elevation decreases both to the east and west as you travel away from the mountains. The lowest points appear to be near the Kansas River/Kansas City area or southeastern Kansas.)

→ MODEL

We are going to make a 3-dimensional map (model) of Colorado and Kansas together. You have two lessons to build it.
Follow instructions in the Appendix for making a basic model, using the Topography of the U.S. map as a guide.

→ NOTE

Make it in the shape of the two states together, and use a tool to draw the boundary between Colorado and Kansas. Be mindful of the lowest areas by making them thinner, but don't worry about adding the mountainous regions because that will be done in the next lesson.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 13

Model of Colorado and Kansas (cont.)

Materials: Materials for Model and Geography Models in the Appendix

→ NOTE

In case you are using additional maps not referenced in the lesson, note that the National Geodetic Survey adjusted the peak of Mt. Elbert 6.55 feet (to 14,440 feet) after adopting more accurate mapping methods.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

∞ Map Link: Topography of the U.S.

1. Locate the Rocky Mountains.
2. Where is the highest ridge in the mountains? (Mt. Elbert. The linked topographic map lists the peak as 14,431 feet, but the atlas lists the peak as 14,433 feet. The elevation in meters is the same on both maps, so the discrepancy could be a rounding error.)
3. How much of Colorado is covered by the Rocky Mountains? (half)

→ MODEL

We are going to finish the 3-dimensional map (model) of Colorado and Kansas.

1. Follow instructions for making a basic model, using the Topography of the U.S. map as a guide.
2. Place a picture of your finished raised relief map in your geography journal as a memento.

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 14

Corn Country

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Have you ever seen corn in a field? Do you know what it looks like before it gets to your grocery store?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

∞ Map Link: Topography of the U.S.

1. Look at the elevation differences between western Kansas and eastern Kansas and Missouri.
2. What is the highest elevation? The lowest elevation? (The highest elevation is where the Great Plains meet Colorado in western Kansas. The lowest elevations are in eastern Missouri along the Mississippi River, in the southeastern corner downstream of the Ohio River confluence.)
3. Does the low elevation stay constant? (The St. Francois Mountains, including Taum Sauk Mountain, interrupt the lower elevations lying west of the Mississippi River. Taum Sauk Mountain is labeled on "The Midwest: Physical Map" of United States Atlas p.84.)

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Missouri" p.101 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Can you find the corn symbol in the map key?
2. Locate corn symbols in Missouri.
3. How many did you find? What do you think this means?
4. Did you notice an area of the map that has no corn symbols? (South Central Missouri) What stands out there? (National Forests and Ozark Plateau)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

p.72-73 “The land seemed” - “ate him up.”

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Label Missouri and anything else you want (possibly a symbol for corn).

WEEK 8 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

Thunderstorm

📄 Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Do you have thunderstorms where you live?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

∞ Map Link: U.S. average Annual Rainfall Map

1. Locate Missouri.
2. Identify rainfall averages for Missouri.
3. Compare rainfall averages in Missouri to those in California to those in your state. Which area gets the most rain? The least? (On average, Missouri receives more annual rainfall than California, except for some very high elevations in California.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-75 “Back in Los Angeles” - “as big as Mr. Evans.”

→ DISCUSS

The weather, landscape, and way of life in the plains of the central U.S. are different from what the Pages were accustomed to in Los Angeles.

1. How were the dust storms and thunderstorms the same? How were they different?
2. Why did Mr. Page have trouble opening a gate, whereas Joe Evans seemed to open it with ease?
3. How are Mr. Evans’s clothes different from Mr. Page’s clothes? Why are they different? Why had Ruth never seen Father wear overalls?

→ VIEW

Here is a cumulonimbus diagram showing how (thunderstorm) clouds form.

∞ Link: Cumulonimbus Diagram

WEEK 8 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

Farm Life

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

What comes to mind when I say farm? Today, we read about Tom and Ruth having fun on the farm. What would you expect children to do to have fun on a farm? Are these the same things children in the city can do for fun?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “Missouri” p.101 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Locate the map key. What are the animal economy symbols? (poultry, sheep, hogs, dairy cows, and beef cattle)
2. Which animals do you find most on the map? (hogs and beef cattle)

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.76-77 “Mr. and Mrs. Evans” - “but I rode it!”

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

Local Stream

Materials: Two pieces of cork or some other floating object, a timer that can time by the second, a map that includes the waterway you visit

PREP: Choose a local stream/creek/river to visit for the focus of this lesson. Briefly familiarize yourself with the Streamer app and the Trace Downstream and Trace Upstream buttons. During term 3, there are more lessons on rivers, but this will be an introduction. For the afternoon occupation, you will need the materials listed above.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Find the creek or river you will be visiting (during the afternoon occupation) on the Streamer web mapping application.

Link: Streamer

1. Locate where you will visit the waterway on the map.
2. Using the map, follow the waterway upstream to its source/head. How far away is it? Is it close enough to visit?
3. Using the map, follow the waterway to its mouth. How far away is it? Is it close enough to visit?
4. Which direction does the waterway flow where you visited? Which general direction does it flow? What large body of water does it empty into?

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Blank map of county or state

1. Draw the waterway you want to visit on your blank map. You may not be able to draw the head and mouth on this map, but draw what part of it is in your county or state.
2. Indicate the flow of the water with arrows.
3. Label the name(s) of the waterway. (The name may change as it joins other watercourses.)

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Missouri spread on p.54-55 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to see what happens to water underground.

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Go for a walk near a creek or river.

Try to find two spots on the creek/river where the water seems to move at different speeds. At each one, measure a distance of, say, 12 feet, and time how long it takes for a piece of cork or some other floating object to go the full 12 feet. Compare the speeds; were they different? If so, why?

Record your findings in your Geography Journal.

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 18

Farm vs. City

Materials: Cross-Country, US Atlas

→ INTRO

What do you think the differences are between life on a farm and in the city? Would you like to live on a farm or in the city? Why?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Missouri” p.101 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. What symbols are in the areas between towns? (You will likely notice livestock or crop symbols.)
2. What symbols are near Kansas City and St. Louis (western and eastern ends of Interstate 70)? (technology, science, manufacturing, etc.) How are they different from the ones in the areas outside of big cities? Are there any in the big cities that are not found elsewhere? (Computers/electronics? Finance/insurance?)

★ TEACHER TIP

PREP for next lesson.

- You will need to go to the grocery store with your student and find produce with labels showing where they were grown. Read the next lesson for more clarity.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-81 "Ruth's clothes" - "five years old!"

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 19

Where is My Food From?

Materials: Globe or World Wall Map, U.S. Atlas

PREP: Go to the grocery store before class and make sure to find fresh fruit or vegetables with labels showing where they were grown.

→ INTRO

Have you ever wondered where the food you eat at home was grown or raised?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: globe or world map

Map Resource: United States Atlas

1. Locate each state or country on the world or U.S. map where one of your fruits or vegetables grew. (You can do this by looking at the label to see where it was grown.)
2. How far did each one travel to get to your local grocery store or farmers' market? (This is a good opportunity to practice using the scale bar on the map.)
3. If it came from very far away, when do you think it was harvested? (Think calendar time as well as stage of ripeness.)
4. Write the fruits and vegetables in your geography journal, along with where they were grown.

★ TEACHER TIP

PREP for next lesson this week.

- You will need a state map for the next lesson.

- Have your child go to the local farmers' market or vegetable stand with you to help pick out fresh fruit and vegetables. Ask the farmer where their farm is, and make a note of it. Read the next lesson for more clarity.

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 20

Where is My Food From?

Materials: Local State Map

PREP: Have your child go to the local farmers' market or vegetable stand with you to help pick out fresh fruit and vegetables. Ask the farmer where their farm is, and make a note of it.
Use a local state map to find where the local farmer's market food is grown.

This lesson is scheduled in the fall for some people, so this can be postponed until the spring if a local market is closed for the season. This Winter Market list and map were updated in 2022. Additionally, a parent can give an oral lesson about this and even go visit some local farms or community gardens to see what they are growing now.

∞ Link: Winter Market

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Your local state map

1. Locate each city or rural area where your fruit or vegetables grew. (You will have to ask the farmer at the market stand and take note of it.)
2. How far did each one travel to get to your local vendor or farmers' market? (You may use the map scale bar for this.)
3. When do you think it was harvested?
4. Write the fruits and vegetables in your geography journal, along with where they were grown.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

Mississippi River

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ INTRO

What is the difference between a lake and a river? How can you tell something is a river?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Missouri” p.101

1. What makes the eastern border of Missouri? (Mississippi River and a small portion of the Des Moines River)
2. What river flows east across the state, going through Kansas City on the western border? (Missouri River)
3. What river joins the Mississippi River just north of St. Louis? (Missouri River)
4. Follow the Mississippi River south and see where it empties into the ocean. (You can use the U.S. wall map or p.8-11 in the United States Atlas.)

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Louisiana” p.69

1. Locate the Mississippi River.
2. What major city lies near the mouth of the river? (New Orleans)
3. What does the river empty into? (Gulf of Mexico)
4. What is the area called where the river joins the gulf? (The Mississippi River Delta; not to be confused with the Mississippi Delta region located approximately 300 miles to the north.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country
p.82-84 “The Pages had crossed” - “do all three.”

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Label St. Louis.
2. Label the Mississippi River.
3. Label Gulf of Mexico (where you have room).
4. Label Illinois.

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Louisiana spread on p.40-41 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn about bayous.

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Deltas and Modeling

Materials: U.S. Atlas, see map work section below, and gather what you need to make a delta.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Physical United States: Physical Map” p.8-9

1. What is the geographic name for the area where the Mississippi River joins the Gulf of Mexico? (Mississippi River Delta)
2. If that’s where it empties, where does it begin? Follow the river upstream from the delta to where it begins—its source. (Minnesota)
3. If you haven’t already identified it, name the source of the Mississippi. (Lake Itasca)

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Louisiana” p.69

1. Locate the Mississippi River.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
2. What was the area called at the mouth of the river? (The Mississippi River Delta) 3. We are going to do an activity to explain what a delta is. → MAP WORK Model: Make a delta. 1. This can be done in a variety of ways, depending on what you have available. (It can be as simple as a pile of dirt or sand in the backyard with a hose, or you can build a model in a large pan or deep cookie sheet using dirt, sand, and a pitcher of water.) 2. What is important is a visual of how water brings the sediment downstream and deposits it at the end of the model river. 3. You probably don't have access to a stream table like the one in the video, but you can see a time-lapse of the creation of a stream, water running down the table, and creating a delta. ∞ Video Link: River Stream Table Time-lapse	
WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 23 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Cross-Country	
WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Cross-Country	

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

Rivers

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, Globe or Wall Map, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Concept: Scale

1. What is scale? (Based on previous lessons, you may mention the bar or line on the map used to measure distance. Let's call that a map scale.)
2. Open your left hand and stretch out your left arm as far as you can. Now study your left palm for a few seconds from that distance.
3. Place your left palm just inches from your nose, close enough that you can still focus on it. Study the palm in this position for a few seconds, too.
4. Both hand positions represent geographic scale. Another way to describe it is geographic extent. When the hand was far away, it looked smaller, but you saw the full extent of the hand; this is called small scale. When the hand was closer, you may have seen less of the hand, but the hand itself looked larger—large scale. Now let's apply this concept to maps!

Map Resource: A globe or wall map

1. Locate the U.S.
2. Look for rivers in the U.S.

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Midwest: Physical Map" p.84

1. Locate Missouri.
2. Look for rivers in Missouri.

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Missouri" p.101

1. Now, how many rivers can you locate in Missouri?
2. What changed as we worked our way from small-scale maps to large-scale maps? (The small-scale maps showed larger geographic extents and large real-world features, but they also represented those features as small and with fewer details. The large-scale maps showed smaller areas and more real-world features, and they also represented those features as larger and with more details.)

Map Resource: Globe or World Wall Map

Find large rivers on each continent. Name them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.85-88 "A river seems" - "has no rivers."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Draw and label any large rivers you found on your maps. (The Ohio River and Kansas River have been mentioned this year as part of the lessons. The Colorado and Mississippi should already be labeled.)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Today's text states that Antarctica has no rivers. Though this is true, Antarctica has a few glacial meltwater streams.

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

Railroads

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, 50 Adventures in 50 States, ruler

→ INTRO

Have you ever seen a train stopped at a railroad crossing? Have you ever wondered what the train was carrying?

→ MAP QUESTIONS



Term 2

🗺️ Map Resource: United States Atlas “Illinois” p.89

1. Locate the scale on the map.
2. Mark on your ruler how far 50 miles is. (Almost 3 centimeters or approximately 1¼ inches)
3. Locate East St. Louis and Chicago.
4. We don’t know which highway the Pages are traveling on, but the inside front cover map of the book shows that they are traveling east across Illinois. Today, we will read that they stop at a train track.
5. Since the map only shows interstate highways, we will choose Interstate 64 as the route closest to the Page family’s likely travels. Let’s imagine that the family stops in the city of Mt. Vernon. Can you trace Interstate 64 eastward from East St. Louis until you find Mt. Vernon? Great!
6. Now, let’s use our ruler and measure how far it is from Mt. Vernon all the way up to Chicago on this map. How far is that? (6 inches)
7. We know the cities are farther apart than 6 inches, so an adult may need to help you calculate how many miles the 6 inches on the map represent. (In order to calculate how far away Chicago would be from the Pages in Mt. Vernon, divide 6 by 1¼, and then multiply by 50 to get 240 miles.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.90-91 “I’m hungry.” - “I’m hungry.”

→ VIEW

The train in the story was heading south from Chicago, which is in Illinois. Take a few minutes to look at the Illinois spread on p.30-31 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn about ice skating in Chicago.

WEEK 2 🗓️ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Population

🗺️ Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

🗺️ Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Political United States: Population” p.16-17

1. Locate Chicago, Illinois.
2. Which color from the population density map key is around Chicago? (Red)
3. Where are the counties with the largest population density? Or where is the darkest red? (The density colors are based on county population density, but the density values are depicted with dots as individual towns and cities. This makes it difficult to locate the actual highest densities—New York City. However, for this exercise, the dark red is barely noticeable near the Los Angeles-Long Beach-Santa Ana metropolitan area in California.)
4. What does the square point symbol mean, according to the urban area population map key? (It will be acceptable to think the symbol represents a city with 5 million people or greater. For the teacher, however, be aware that ‘urban area’ includes all of the city’s neighboring incorporated and unincorporated areas that define the economic region.)
5. How much of the U.S. has population densities of fewer than 1? (Most of the Midwest and West)
6. Think back to the Pages driving through the prairie. What does low population density look like? (Houses are spread farther apart)
7. Name three urban areas with a population of 5 million or greater. (Choices are Greater Los Angeles, Dallas-Fort Worth metroplex, Greater Houston, Chicago metropolitan area, Metro Atlanta, Miami metropolitan area, Greater Philadelphia, and New York City.)
8. Name five urban areas with populations less than 5 million but no smaller than 1 million—the triangle symbol.

★ TEACHER NOTE

PREP for next lesson: Locate the local or street map of your area used in Term 1.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

9. Now, find approximately where you live. What is the population density there? Are you from a small town/city? Do people live far apart or near each other?

10. Which city shown on this map is close to where you live? What is its urban area population?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.92-94 “By the time” - “just like yours.”

→ MAP WORK

□ Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Indiana.

WEEK 2 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Your Town

□ Materials: Street map of your area (from previous lesson)

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: A map of your city, either a hard copy or a digital version

1. Locate your street. (A parent will probably need to help.) Can you locate your home on this map?
2. Do you live within the city limits?
3. Locate any parks or outdoor areas in your city. What direction would you travel to get there? Are there any within walking distance from your home?
4. Do you have a downtown or city center? If so, what direction would you travel from your home to get there?
5. Locate your local seat of government—city hall, town hall, or municipal building. Do you live north, south, east, or west of it?
6. How are the streets laid out in your city? Is any portion of your city laid out in a grid? (Older areas may utilize the grid; newer sections may utilize cul-de-sacs; and other patterns like loop roads and diagonals may be used.)
7. If so, in what direction do the streets run? (North-south, east-west, etc.)
8. What are the streets named in this area? Do you see any “streets”, “avenues”, or “lanes”? What other street types (e.g., way, court, parkway) can you find? Is there a pattern for when these names are used (such as cul-de-sacs being “courts”)?
9. Are there differences in the way streets are laid out near the center city compared to near your home?
10. Look for familiar places (grocery stores you go to, places of worship, friends’ homes, etc.). How would you travel there from your home?
11. Choose one of the familiar places you found and find at least 2 different routes to travel there from your home. Which one do you think is faster?

→ NOTE

Keep the street map for the next lesson. Pay attention on walks/rides this week, noting things you saw on the map, or answering questions that came up during the map exercises.

WEEK 3 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Your Town

□ Materials: Street map of your area (from previous lesson)

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: A map of your city, either a hard copy or a digital version

1. Locate your street.
2. Locate your local police department, fire station, and hospital. How would you travel there from your home?
3. Do you have more than one police station, fire station, or hospital? If so,



Term 2

- mark where they are located. Are they close to each other or far apart? What do you notice about how they are spaced?
4. Can you find any bodies of water or watercourses? (oceans, lakes, reservoirs, ponds, wetlands, rivers, streams, creeks, and so forth)
 5. Using the scale, estimate the distance of the closest water feature to your house. How far is it? Could you walk there? Drive there? How long would it take?
 6. How many bodies of water are there in your city?
 7. If your map shows physical features, can you tell which direction the rivers, streams, or creeks run? Do they all flow in the same direction?
 8. Can you see smaller tributaries that flow into larger ones?
 9. What is the largest body of water in your city?

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 30

Coal Mine

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ INTRO

Do you wear the same clothes to school or church that you wear when playing sports? Do you wear different clothes or shoes during your nature walks?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Kentucky” p.66-67 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Find the economy symbol for coal.
2. Can you find this symbol on the map of Kentucky? If so, where? (Most are in the eastern side of Kentucky.)
3. What is this general area called? (Cumberland Plateau)

Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Political United States: Energy” p.20-21

1. Locate Kentucky.
2. What is the major (nonrenewable) energy source in Kentucky? (coal)
3. What other energy sources are found in Kentucky? (natural gas and petroleum)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.95-97 “What funny-looking” - “coal miners?”

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

1. Label Kentucky.
2. Try drawing the coal economy symbol in the eastern part of the state.

→ VIEW

The landscape that makes Kentucky good for the natural resources we read about also makes it good for other things. Take a few minutes to look at the Kentucky spread on p.38-39 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn about rock climbing.

WEEK 4 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

Tennessee

Materials: U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Political United States: Political Map” p.14-15

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

1. Locate Kentucky.
2. Name the state neighboring Kentucky to the south. (Tennessee)

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Physical United States: Physical Map” p.8-9

1. Locate Tennessee.
2. What rivers with labels do you see either inside or along the borders of Tennessee? (Mississippi, Tennessee, and Cumberland)

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “Tennessee” p.76-77

1. What shapes the western border of Tennessee? (Mississippi River)
2. What river runs through Nashville? (Cumberland River)
3. What river runs through Chattanooga? (Tennessee River)
4. What shapes the eastern border? (It’s not a river, but the line is still squiggly.) Look for the big text arching over the border. (Appalachian Mountains)

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Tennessee.

WEEK 4 📄 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 32 *Nashville*

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Political United States: Political Map” p.14-15, then “Climate” p.10-11, and then “Physical Map” p.8-9

1. Locate Nashville, Tennessee. Remember its location for the next two maps.
2. What is the climate zone for Nashville? (temperate wet)
3. What vegetation grows in Tennessee? (broadleaf forest)
4. Locate Los Angeles, California. Remember its location for the next two maps.
5. Compare the climate zones of Los Angeles and Nashville. (Los Angeles is dry summer, but Nashville is wet. However, both are listed as temperate.
6. Compare the natural vegetation of Los Angeles and Nashville. (Los Angeles has grassland vegetation and is located at the base of mixed forests, which are a mixture of needleleaf and broadleaf trees. Nashville is located in a broadleaf forest area.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.98-100 “Ruth and Tom” - “but he did.”

Show students the picture on p.98, and ask what clue in the picture lets you know that the story takes place in the capital city. (Only one background building is shown in detail. It appears to be placed prominently on a hill and designed with elaborate architecture. Does this look like a Capitol building to you?)

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Nashville.

WEEK 5 📄 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 33 *Borders*

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map

PREP: If you are reading this online, print a copy of the inside front map of Cross-Country to look at while the story is read today. If you have the



Term 2

printed copy, just reference the front map.

→ INTRO

Before you read, place the inside front cover map before the students. Ask what the red line, red stars, squiggly blue lines, and dashed black lines represent. If they don't know, tell them that we will discover the answer(s) in today's lesson.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

1. Look at the inside front cover map of Cross-Country.
2. Read Tom's questions from the first column of today's reading as if you are actually asking those questions.
3. Pause after each question to allow students to answer.
4. For example, read, "Was Denver in Colorado or Kansas? A look at the map told him." Now let the student check the map and respond before reading Tom's next question.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.101 "After two weeks" - "no river there."

→ MAP WORK

☐ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Using a colored pencil, trace over any state borders formed by rivers. Use the Cross-Country map as your reference, and label the rivers.

WEEK 5 ☐ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Capitals

☐ Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ INTRO

Ask students if they have ever ridden in a car to a different state. What did the state line look like?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

☐ Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Political United States: Political Map" p.14-15

1. Locate state capitals.
2. What symbol represents a state capital? (a star within a single circle)
3. How is this different from the symbols for other cities? (Other cities are depicted as solid black dots of varying size, dependent upon population. Washington, D.C. is shown as a star within a double circle.)
4. Identify the state capitals for every state the Pages have traveled through. These are the states: California, Nevada, Arizona, Utah, Colorado, Kansas, Missouri, Illinois, Indiana, Kentucky, and Tennessee.

☐ Map Resource: Inside front cover of Cross-Country

1. Can you find the state capitals on this map? What are they marked with? (A red star within a white circle)
2. Which state capitals have the Pages traveled through so far? (Salt Lake City, Utah; Denver, Colorado; Topeka, Kansas; Jefferson City, Missouri; and Nashville, Tennessee)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.102-103 "We have been"- "Movie stars!"

→ MAP WORK

☐ Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Label the capital city of the state you live in, and also add the capitals the Pages drove through. (If drawing a symbol different from regular cities, do not use a star within a double circle since lesson 2 of the previous year

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

used it for Washington, D.C. Previous lessons involved labeling Denver and Nashville, but drawing symbols representing capitals was not specified. If adding Raleigh, Richmond, or Annapolis to the map, leave room for North Carolina, Virginia, or Maryland to be labeled in future lessons.)

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

Appalachian Mountains

Materials: Cross-Country, United States Atlas, Grandma Gatewood

→ INTRO

Have you ever visited the mountains? Or seen them from a car or plane? Or even traveled up a mountain? If so, do you know where the mountains were? Are you able to describe the mountain(s)?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Inside front of Cross-Country

1. Locate Nashville, Tennessee.
2. Locate Great Smoky Mountains National Park nearby.
3. What direction do you travel to get from Nashville to the Great Smoky Mountains National Park? (east)
4. What larger mountain range is this national park a part of? (Appalachian Mountains)

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" p.8-9

1. Explore the topography cross-section located at the bottom of these pages. This is what you would see if you drew a straight line from San Francisco, California, to Washington, D.C., cut along the line, and then tilted the top portion so you could view it from the side instead of from the top.
2. Compare the height of the Appalachian Mountains with the Rocky Mountains. Based on this observation, what do you think the Appalachian Mountains will be like?
3. Looking now at the main map, what vegetation would you expect in the Appalachian Mountains along the eastern Tennessee border? (broadleaf forests)

Map Resource: Inside cover of Grandma Gatewood

1. Read the title of the key. How many smaller ranges are a part of the Appalachian Mountains? (8)
2. Locate the Great Smoky Mountains on the southern end.

WEEK 6 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Appalachian Mountains

Materials: Grandma Gatewood

→ NOTE

Grandma Gatewood pages are not numbered, so consider page 2 to start "Between eleven children" and number accordingly from there.

→ INTRO

We are going to read a book together that will teach us a good bit about the Appalachian Mountains.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-6 "Between eleven children" - "entire trail!"

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: p.5-6 of Grandma Gatewood

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

1. Find where Emma started. What is it named? (Mt. Oglethorpe)
2. In what state did she start? (Georgia)
3. What 3 states does this map show? (Georgia, North Carolina, Tennessee)
4. Locate Great Smoky Mountains National Park.
5. The AT (Appalachian Trail) goes through many National Forests. How many can you find on this map? (5)

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 37

Great Smoky Mountains

Materials: Cross-Country, 50 Adventures in 50 States

PREP: Test both the NPS interactive map and the NPS PDF map from the U.S. National Park Service to see which one works best for you. The PDF map can also be viewed in the interactive map by changing the upper left drop-down menu from Park Tiles to Brochure.

∞ Map Link: NPS interactive map

∞ Map Link: NPS PDF map

→ INTRO

We will get back to Grandma Gatewood in a couple of weeks, but we are going to spend some time hearing more about one of the places she hiked through, the Great Smoky Mountains. The Great Smoky Mountains National Park is consistently the most visited national park in the U.S. (The next most visited national park is Grand Canyon National Park, but it only attracts about half as many visitors yearly.) Even when Cross-Country was published in 1950, Great Smoky Mountains National Park was still the most visited national park. If millions of people annually visit this national park more than any other, we should probably spend a few days exploring what it has to offer. Enjoy your visit!

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: NPS interactive map or NPS PDF map of Great Smoky Mountains National Park

1. What is the highest elevation you can find in the park? (Clingmans Dome at 6,643 feet above sea level)
2. In which two states is the park located? (Tennessee and North Carolina)
3. Can you find the state line on the map?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.104-105 “As soon as” - “anywhere in the United States.”

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Tennessee spread on p.88-89 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to read about something that happens in the Great Smoky Mountains in late spring.

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 38

Great Smoky Mountains

Materials: Cross-Country

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: NPS interactive map or the NPS PDF map of Great Smoky Mountains National Park

∞ Map Link: NPS interactive map or NPS PDF map

1. Where do you think the most trees will be located? What about fish?
2. Can you find the creeks, rivers, and lakes?
3. Change the upper right drop-down menu (if using the interactive map) from Park Tiles to Park Tiles Imagery if you want to see the real trees and water.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

∞ Map Link: Species Mapper

1. Look at the National Park Service's Species Mapper. You choose an animal or tree from the drop-down list entitled "SELECT A SPECIES". For example, choose American Beech to see its spatial distribution inside the park.
2. Next, use the "COMPARE WITH ANOTHER SPECIES IN THE PARK" drop-down list to select American Elm. How does its distribution compare?
3. Select American Mountain Ash as the second tree to compare.
4. Now, select a Brown Trout in the drop-down list to see where they are located.
5. Now, select a flower from the "SELECT A SPECIES" drop-down list. (Be sure to check out rosebay rhododendron, and choose mountain laurel from the "COMPARE WITH SPECIES WITH SIMILAR DISTRIBUTION" drop-down list.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.106-108 "We'll see lots" - "look like smoke."

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 39

Model of Mountain Landscape

Materials: Cross-Country, Materials for Model, and Geography Models Document in Appendix

PREP: Students are building a mountain landscape out of clay. The landscape must be big enough for students to observe water flowing down slopes, valleys, and rivers in the next lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.109 "Here is a picture" - "of the earth."

→ MODEL

1. Follow instructions for making a basic model.
2. Your landscape should include: mountains, valleys, canyons, rivers, and a large body of water (lake, sea, or ocean)
3. After it has dried, paint the model to help seal the clay. (Do this during an afternoon before your next geography lesson.)

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 40

Model with Mountains and Rivers

Materials: Cross-Country, completed model, watering can

PREP: Note If the painted model is not dry, you may do this lesson during an afternoon later in the week. The model has to be dry and sealed with paint for it to work at its best. You may even continue the project during your assessment week.

Bookmark maps on p.58-60, 86-88, and 110-112 in Cross-Country.

→ MODEL

1. By now, your landscape should be formed and painted.
2. If your mountain model is thoroughly dry, you may use a watering can to rain on your landscape. Notice where the water runs, and where it gathers. Did it do what you expected?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Physical feature hemisphere maps on p.58-60, 86-88, and 110-112 in Cross-Country

1. Rivers empty into larger bodies of water, and most of the largest rivers flow into an ocean. If you look at only the maps on p.58-60, can you guess where some rivers may begin? (in higher elevations or mountains)
2. Now, look at only the rivers on p.86-88. If you look only at this map, and

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

you know that a river empties into an ocean, where would you guess the mountains would be on this map? (where those rivers begin)

3. When geographers want to study spatial relationships between different observations, they will overlay (or stack on top of one another) maps of the different phenomena. This makes it so much easier to understand how rivers and mountains are interconnected. Let's look at overlays of these Cross-Country maps today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.110-112 "On this map" to "do not melt."

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: Physical map of the Western Hemisphere on p.110 of Cross-Country

1. Which general direction do rivers in Tennessee flow? (The Tennessee River does not appear to prefer any single cardinal direction other than West. Rivers on the western side of the Appalachians flow westward, with most eventually joining the Mississippi River before reaching the Gulf of Mexico.)

2. Which general direction will the rivers in North Carolina flow? (east toward the Atlantic Ocean)

WEEK 9 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 41

Appalachian Trail

□ Materials: Grandma Gatewood, U.S. Atlas

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: United States Atlas "Tennessee" p.77

□ Map Resource: Grandma Gatewood map p.5-6

1. Locate the Appalachian Mountains in the U.S. Atlas.

2. Locate the Great Smoky Mountains, and find the highest point in Tennessee there. What is it? (Clingman's Dome) What is its height? (6,643 ft.)

3. Look in Grandma Gatewood and locate Clingman's Dome.

4. Looking at both maps, what seems to be the boundary between Tennessee and North Carolina? (Appalachian Mountains)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grandma Gatewood

p.6-10 "The Appalachian Trail" - "known as 'Grandma' Gatewood."

WEEK 9 □ 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 42

Appalachian Trail

□ Materials: Grandma Gatewood, U.S. Atlas, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ MAP QUESTIONS

□ Map Resource: United States Atlas "Virginia" p.78-79

□ Map Resource: Grandma Gatewood map p.11-12

1. Locate the Appalachian Mountains in the U.S. Atlas.

2. Locate the yellow National Park unit area along the Tennessee border, and find the highest point in Virginia there. What is it? (Mt. Rogers) What is its height? (5,729 ft.)

3. Look in Grandma Gatewood and locate Mt. Rogers.

4. Looking at both maps, what seems to be the boundary between Virginia and West Virginia? (Appalachian Mountains)

5. Name the national parks and national forests that are near the trail. (Jefferson National Forest, George Washington National Forest, Shenandoah National Park)

6. What river does Emma have to cross going into Maryland? (Potomac River)

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grandma Gatewood

p.11-16 "Harpers Ferry" - "known as 'went on forever.'"

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Virginia and West Virginia spreads on p.96-97, 100-101 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn a little more about the world's longest trail as well as New River Gorge.

(Look at similarities on p.97 with Grandma Gatewood on p.16)

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 43

Appalachian Trail

Materials: Grandma Gatewood, U.S. Atlas, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Pennsylvania" p.46-47

Map Resource: Grandma Gatewood map on p.17-18

1. Locate the Appalachian Mountains in the U.S. Atlas.
2. Locate the Allegheny Mountains. These are not listed in Grandma Gatewood but are another portion of the Appalachian Mountains.
3. The highest point in Pennsylvania is in the Allegheny Mountains. What is it? (Mt. Davis) What is its height? (3,213 ft.)
4. Have you noticed anything about the highest points in the last few states? (Maybe that they are all in the App. Mtns; maybe they are noticing that the numbers are going down.)
5. If you have not noticed, you can look back at the heights of the mountains in the last few states and see that they are decreasing. Take some time to wonder about that.
6. On the Grandma Gatewood map, what rivers do you see? (Susquehanna River, Delaware River, Hudson River) I wonder how Emma will get across them?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grandma Gatewood

p.18-22 "Pennsylvania is" - "East Coast."

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Pennsylvania, New York, and New Jersey spreads on p.80-81, 68-69, and 64. 65 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn a little more about the other wonderful things in these states.

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 44

Appalachian Trail

Materials: Grandma Gatewood, U.S. Atlas, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "Connecticut" p.31, "Massachusetts" p.38-39, and "Vermont" p.51

Map Resource: Grandma Gatewood map on the inside cover

1. On the inside cover map of Emma's journey, locate the Taconics on the key and on the map.
2. Look at the 3 state maps in the United States Atlas and see if you can find the Taconic Range on each one.
3. On the inside cover map of Emma's journey, locate the Green Mountains on the key and on the map. See if you can find them on the Vermont Map, p.51.
4. On the Massachusetts Map, p.38-39, locate the highest point in the

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

state. (Mt. Greylock) What is its height? (1,064 m (3,491 ft)) Is it lower than the last mountain we checked? (no)

5. On the Vermont Map p.51, locate the highest point. (It is near the "i" in the Green Mountains. Mt. Mansfield) What is its height? (4,393 ft) It is much higher than it has been in a while. Wonder about that.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grandma Gatewood

p.23-30 "The writer Herman" - "alone again."

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Connecticut and Massachusetts spreads on p.18-19 and 46-47 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn a little more about the other wonderful things in these states.

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 45

Appalachian Trail

Materials: Grandma Gatewood, U.S. Atlas, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "New Hampshire" p.41, "Maine" p.35

Map Resource: Grandma Gatewood map on the inside cover

1. On the inside cover map of Emma's journey, locate the White Mountains on the key and on the map.

2. Look at the New Hampshire map in the United States Atlas and see if you can find the White Mountains.

3. In that area, locate the highest point in New Hampshire. (Mt. Washington) What is its height? (6,288 ft)

4. On the inside cover map of Emma's journey, locate the Mahoosucs on the key and on the map. They are not marked on the Maine map, p.35, but another one is named. Can you find it? (Longfellow Mountains)

5. On the Maine Map, p.35, locate the highest point in the state. (Mt. Katahdin) What is its height? (5,268 ft) Is it lower or higher than the last mountain we checked? (higher)

6. What state park is Mt. Katahdin located in? (Baxter State Park)

7. On p.31-32 in Grandma Gatewood, locate Mt. Washington, Mt. Katahdin, and Baxter State Park.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Grandma Gatewood

p.31-38 "The second-fastest" - "said Emma."

→ READ

Take a few minutes to look at the New Hampshire and Vermont spreads on p.62-63 and 94-95 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn a little more about Mt. Washington and Fall in Vermont.

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 46

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH-UP

Use today to finish any work or walks from the term.

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
Questions will come from: Cross-Country	
WEEK 12  20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i>	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
Questions will come from: Grandma Gatewood	

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 49

The Forest

Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ INTRO

What sounds do you think you might hear in a forest?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.114-116 "A forest does something" - "it is you."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label North Carolina.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

We are going to practice listening for a few minutes, and next lesson we will make a sound map.

1. What different kinds of sounds do you hear in different rooms/areas of your home or school?
2. If your eyes were closed, do you think you would know which room you were in based just on the sounds?
3. Test your hearing sense by choosing to:
a-Close your eyes, have someone lead you to different rooms, and you guess which room you are in; OR
b-Have someone record sound for 15 seconds (on a phone or recorder of some type) in various rooms, play each one for you to hear, and you guess the respective room.
4. Draw pictures to represent each of the places you "heard."

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the North Carolina spread on p.70-71 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn about something underwater off the coast of North Carolina.

WEEK 1 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 50

Outdoor Sound Map

PREP: John Muir Laws has a Nature Journal Connection video about making sound maps. The video is 14 minutes long, so it may be good to watch it ahead of time and use the time today to do the actual sound map.
∞ Video Link: JML Sound Map

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

1. Find a spot outside where you can listen. Take a paper and a pencil.
2. Face north, and draw yourself or a symbol to represent yourself in the middle of your paper.
3. Spend time (per the video) listening.
4. Add to your map the sounds you hear.

WEEK 2 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 51

The Forest (cont.)

Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Name some things made of wood. I wonder where the wood came from to make those things?

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.116-117 “Yet the forest” to “smoke anyway.”

WEEK 2 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 52

The Forest (cont.)

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “The Physical United States: Natural Hazards” p.12-13

1. Find the symbol for wildfire.
2. Where have there been large wildfires in the past 40 years?
3. Today’s reading is also about a wildfire. It is not as big as the ones on this map, but wildfires happen in many forests.

Map Resource: United States Atlas “North Carolina” p.72-73

1. Locate the Great Smoky Mountains. What color is it on the map? (yellow)
2. To the south and east are green shaded areas. What are they? (National Forests)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.117-118 “Yes, the forest ranger” - “glad it’s there.”

• TAKE A GEOGRAPHY WALK

Take a walk in a nearby forest. The Discover the Forest website will help you locate a forest near your ZIP Code.

∞ Link: Discover the Forest

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 53

North Carolina Crops

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ NOTES

1. When Cross-Country was published in 1950, North Carolina ranked first in the U.S. in tobacco production, second in peanuts, and seventh in cotton. Seventy years later, North Carolina still ranks first in tobacco, fifth in peanuts, and tenth in cotton.
2. Based on when the book was written, there is no mention of the health effects of tobacco. Teachers should use their discretion when discussing tobacco and responding to related questions.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “North Carolina” p.72-73 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Look at the map key and find the symbols for cotton and tobacco.
2. Find them on the map. What do you notice about where they are? (Cotton symbols appear mostly in the eastern half of the state, with a few in the south-central portion. Tobacco production is distributed across the entire state, except in the national forests of the mountains.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.119-120 “Some of the crops” - “dress or a shirt.”

WEEK 3 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 54

North Carolina Crops (cont.)

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

The Page family will see peanut plants today. What do you think a peanut plant looks like? Have you ever shelled peanuts?

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “North Carolina” p.72. 73 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Look at the map key and find the symbol for peanuts.
2. Find it on the map. What do you notice about where peanuts are farmed? (major production is in the northeast)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.121 “Farther east” - “very well.”

WEEK 4 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 55

Industry and Economy

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “North Carolina” p.72. 73 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Using the map grid, locate grid bars 3 and 6.
2. Identify two economy symbols shown on the map in the range of grid bars 3, 4, 5, and 6 that represent manufacturing industries (factories). In other words, which symbols are for items that have to be made? (Clothing/textiles and furniture; students may say computers/electronics, but there are more furniture symbols in this specific area.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.122-123 “In July” - “furniture factories.”

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Label Raleigh. If you have been using a special symbol for capital cities, remember to use it here.

WEEK 4 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 56

Industry and Economy (cont.)

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

📄 Map Resource: United States Atlas “North Carolina” p.72-73 (See 5th ed. PDF, if needed.)

∞ PDF Link: 5th edition PDF

1. Identify the two livestock symbols that appear the most. (poultry/eggs and hogs)
2. North Carolina ranks first among the 50 states in poultry/eggs, and it ranks second in hogs and pigs.
3. The state also ranks second in the production of a certain commodity that becomes popular every December and, since 1971, has been hand-selected for showcasing and decorating at the White House 13 times. Can you guess what it is? (Christmas tree)
4. Where on the map do you think Christmas trees would grow? (the mountains, specifically the northern mountains)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.124-126 “Suppose you are now” - “like North Carolina.”

★ TEACHER NOTE

Discretion must be used again regarding the topic of tobacco, this time for all of p.124. You can skip reading about manufacturing cigarettes if desired.

● EXTRA HELPING

Watch this video on harvesting and processing peanuts.

∞ **Video Link:** Harvesting and Processing Peanuts

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Draw any economic symbols of interest within North Carolina.

WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 57

Atlantic Ocean

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas “Virginia” p.78-79

1. What is along the western border of Virginia? (The Appalachian Mountains. Specifically, the unlabeled Cumberland Mountains along the Kentucky border and the Allegheny Mountains along the West Virginia border.)
2. West Virginia wraps around the northern tip of Virginia. Name the state situated east of West Virginia at this tip. (Maryland)
3. Name the river separating Virginia from Maryland. (Potomac)
4. Name the first waterbody the Potomac flows into. (Chesapeake Bay)
5. Chesapeake Bay is an inland extension of what large body of water? (Atlantic Ocean)
6. Today’s story takes place at the confluence of the Chesapeake and the Atlantic. Which city would that be? (Virginia Beach)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.127-128 “From North Carolina” - ““them is wrong!””

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map

Label Virginia and ATLANTIC OCEAN. Writing the ocean name in ALL CAPS sets it apart as a prominent feature, just like we did with the Pacific.

WEEK 5 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 58

Gulfs and Bays

Materials: Cross-Country, Student World Atlas, Globe or World Wall Map, My U.S. Map

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas “North America: Physical Map” p.56

1. Locate the Gulf of Alaska, Hudson Bay, and Baffin Bay.
2. Do you notice any differences between the bays and the gulf? (The gulf is more “open” or wider.)
3. Can you find any more gulfs or bays on this map? (Gulf of Mexico and Chesapeake Bay)
4. Take a few minutes to look at your world wall map or globe. See if you can find other bays or gulfs.
5. What did you notice about the differences between them? (You may notice that some bays look like gulfs, and some gulfs look like bays. Typically, bays are smaller than gulfs. Both bays and gulfs are portions of larger bodies of water that extend into the land. They also have wide mouths where they join the larger body of water, but gulfs can sometimes have narrow mouths as well, like the Persian Gulf. The Bay of Biscay, north of Spain and France, is actually a gulf.)
6. Read the following definition: National Geographic defines a bay as “a body of water partly surrounded by land. A bay is usually smaller and less enclosed than a gulf. The mouth of the bay, where [it] meets the ocean or lake, is typically wider than that of a gulf. “

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Cross-Country
p.129-130 “At Virginia Beach” - “little finger in it.”

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Chesapeake Bay. This may require you to draw an arrow from your label in the Atlantic Ocean to the narrow bay.

WEEK 6 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 59

Model of Bay

📄 Materials: Cross-Country, pan, water, large rock(s)

→ MODEL

Look at the illustration at the bottom of p.129 in Cross-Country. This is the headland—specifically, Cape Henry—where the Pages turned toward the west. Can you see the difference in the wave sizes as mentioned in the story? The waves between the shore and the horizon are larger than the small waves around the “corner”. Which waves are from the ocean, and which waves are from the bay? (Ocean waves are large, and bay waves are small.)

1. Cover the bottom of a shallow pan with water—maybe halfway up.
2. Blow across the pan and watch the waves.
3. Next, place a big rock or other object in the pan so that it rises above the water.
4. Now, blow across the pan where the object is now in the waves.
5. Does the size or choppiness of the waves differ between open water wind and obstructed wind?
6. Add a sketch to your journal diagramming ocean waves versus bay waves.

WEEK 6 📅 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 60

The Harbor

📄 Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Do you know what a harbor is? Have you ever been to one?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.131 “Look at all” - “for a harbor.”

→ DISCUSS (BASED ON PHOTO)

1. Describe what you see in the illustration on p.131. (railroad, freight train, dock, pickup truck, large cargo vessels, smooth water, and land across the water)
2. How do all of these objects in the picture work together to function as a harbor?
3. Hampton Roads is often referred to as one of the largest natural harbors in the world. It is also home to the world’s largest naval station.
4. You will read tomorrow that the Page family could not drive across Hampton Roads and would have to drive around it. Since that time, two separate bridge tunnels have been opened for vehicular traffic across the harbor.
5. Look at this picture of one of the bridge tunnels. Would you have ever thought to build both a bridge and a tunnel just to get across the water? (Note that a drawbridge probably would have sufficed, but the naval fleet would be trapped in the harbor if the bridge collapsed. A tunnel cannot block ships on the water.)
∞ Image Link: Hampton Roads Bridge Tunnel

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 61

The Harbor (cont.)

Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

If there were no bridge or tunnel across Hampton Roads when the Page family visited, how did they get across?

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Cross-Country p.130

1. Locate the Chesapeake Bay.
2. Locate the Hampton Roads Harbor.
3. What cities are located around Hampton Roads? (Newport News, Portsmouth, Norfolk) I wonder why they are there. (Answers will vary, such as to be near the water, to be able to dock ships, etc.)
4. Can you locate the large river that empties into Hampton Roads Harbor? It is not labeled, but it is the James River.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.132 "Mother showed" - "that we are on."

WEEK 7 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 62

The Oceans

Materials: Cross-Country

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Cross-section on Cross-Country p.133

1. What parts of the cross-section are the lowest? (the Pacific Ocean on the left and the Atlantic Ocean on the right)
2. If you poured water on the Rocky Mountains in the cross-section, where would it flow to? (the Pacific Ocean on one side and the Mississippi River on the other side)
3. If you poured water on the Appalachian Mountains in the cross-section, where would it flow? (to the Mississippi River on one side and the Atlantic Ocean on the other side)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.133 "We have all" - "There it stops."

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 63

The Oceans Continued

Materials: Cross-Country, Globe

→ INTRO

Can you name the four (or five) oceans of the world? (There are officially five oceans on Earth. The Southern Ocean was officially recognized by National Geographic in 2021 to describe the waters surrounding Antarctica.) How about the seven (7) continents?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.134-136 "The Pacific Ocean" - "four large parts."

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Cross-Country p.134-136

Map Resource: Globe

1. Look back at the three (3) hemisphere maps (p.134-136).
2. Spin the globe to match the first drawing.
3. Which continents touch the Pacific Ocean? (Australia, Asia, North America, South America, and possibly Antarctica. Note that Antarctica is

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

not clearly shown as touching the Pacific Ocean in the book illustrations. Officially, the Southern Ocean touches Antarctica.)

4. Which oceans touch the Pacific Ocean? (Arctic, Atlantic, Indian, and Southern)

5. Repeat this model for the remaining two maps, and make sure that all oceans are mentioned.

You should recognize that continents drain to more than one ocean. You should also see that all oceans are connected.

WEEK 8 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 64

Washington, D.C.

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ INTRO

Have you ever been to Washington, D.C.? If so, what do you remember about your time there? The Pages have made it to Washington, D.C. Let's spend some time looking at a map of it.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Political United States: The National Capital" p.22-23

1. What river runs through Washington, D.C.? (The Potomac River is depicted on the enlarged map. The overall map, however, shows the Anacostia River as well.)

2. What do the light green areas represent? (parks and open areas)

3. What do the red parts represent? (major points of interest)

4. Can you find the U.S. Capitol on the map? There is a picture of it on p.23.

Map Resource: Cross-Country "Home in Washington, D.C." p.137

1. Explore the illustrations and see if you recognize anything.

2. Compare features in the illustration with features in the Atlas map. Are you able to match buildings, streets, parks, etc.?

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 65

The Congress

Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

Remember that each state has different laws, and those laws are made by men and women working in the state capitol building. I wonder who makes the laws for our country—all 50 states? Where do they meet?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.138-139 "On his first day" - "is the voter."

WEEK 9 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 66

The President

Materials: Cross-Country

→ INTRO

What tasks are part of the job of the President of the U.S.? Where does the President work? Where does the President live?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.140-141 "After they left" - "people are the boss."

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 67

Washington, D.C.

Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map, 50 Adventures in 50 States

→ NOTES

1. Today's reading mentions 48 states. Be prepared to mention that Alaska and Hawaii gained statehood nine (9) years after this book was published.
2. Eleven years after Cross-Country was published, the Twenty-Third Amendment to the U.S. Constitution gave Washington, D.C., residents the right to vote for President. The District has the fewest number of electors in the Electoral College. Since Washington, D.C., is not located in a state, it does not have representatives in Congress.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Look over this linked Map of Washington, D.C., and the surrounding area.
∞ Map Link: Map of Washington, D.C.

1. Find Washington, D.C., on the map.
2. Can you tell that the District was originally located on land donated by two states? Which two states donated land for the federal district? (Maryland and Virginia)
3. About 50 years after the donation, one state received its portion back. The light yellow part was given back; the dark yellow part was not. Which state received their portion back? (Virginia)
4. Notice all the small towns around Washington, D.C. There are a lot of choices for people to live in who work in the Washington, D.C., area.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.142-143 "After Mother and the children" - "save a thousand dollars."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Label Maryland.

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at the Maryland spread on p.44-45 of 50 Adventures in 50 States to learn about an old canal.

WEEK 10 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 68

Review of the Journey

Materials: Cross-Country, My U.S. Map

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Inside front map of Cross-Country (may have been printed for lesson 37)

Try to remember some of the people the Pages met on their journey across the country. Follow along with the story and point out on the map where they were as I read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.144-146 "It was almost time" - "and the nation great."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: My U.S. Map
Before we say goodbye to the Pages, is there anything else you would like to add to your map?

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 69

Physical Map vs. Political Map

Materials: Cross-Country, U.S. Atlas

→ NOTE

The maps in today's Cross-Country reading show some political entities as dependencies (shaded), but their statuses have obviously changed since 1950. There are still countries today that do not have sovereign rule and are, therefore, not considered independent nations.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: United States Atlas "The Physical United States: Physical Map" and "The Political United States: Political Map" p.8-9, 14-15
1. Compare the physical and political maps, flipping back and forth as needed.

2. What do you notice that is different on the political map? (Answers will vary, possibly noticing things like different colored boundary lines, dotted lines between states, capital cities, and other major cities are shown.)

3. If they didn't notice state outlines, point those out. Have you ever driven on a highway and seen a sign saying you are entering a state? You were crossing a state line but were not able to see the line.

4. Looking at the physical map, does the U.S. look more broken up or less broken up compared to the political map? (Representing the state boundaries with thin lines, and not assigning different colors to each one, allows you to see the country more as a whole than as 50 separate units.)

5. Look at the title page spread of the United States Atlas (p.2-3), and you will see an image from outer space of the U.S. Does it look more broken up or less broken up than the political or physical maps? (less) Do you see any lines on this map? (no)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Cross-Country

p.147-149 "The United States of America" - "make a continent."

WEEK 11 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 70

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings. You may also want to look at any other states in 50 Adventures in 50 States.

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Cross-Country

WEEK 12 20m Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.) - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Activities and Models from the term

Geography: Grade 3 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

- Cross-Country: Based on your reading and model, tell what you know about the terrain and elevation of Kansas compared to Colorado. How does this affect what grows and lives in these different states?
- Tell what you know about your local waterway, including where it originates and empties into, OR about the Mississippi River.

Term 2

- Cross-Country: Regarding a river, tell what you know about how water moves. Use what you observed in your model this term to help explain the process.
- Grandma Gatewood: Describe some things you would like to see if you traveled the Appalachian Trail.

Term 3

- Cross-Country: Tell what you know about bays, gulfs, and harbors. OR Tell what you learned about the economy of North Carolina.
- Tell about your sound map from the beginning of the term. How did you make the map, and what do you remember from it?